

Jared Kushner donates \$1 million to Chabad of United Arab Emirates after rabbi murdered

Kushner, who is married to Ivanka Trump, described Zvi Kogan's work as a 'shining light in the world and a strong counter to the history of division'

By Jacob Kornbluh

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Jared Kushner, President-elect Donald Trump's son-in-law and former Middle East adviser, announced on Monday a \$1 million donation to the Chabad center in the United Arab Emirates following the horrific murder of Rabbi Zvi Kogan, a local Chabad emissary.

"Ivanka and I will be donating \$1 million to the Chabad of UAE and will redouble our efforts to work with the Jewish community and the country's leadership to build a resilient, vibrant Jewish community in Abu Dhabi and Dubai," Kushner said in a statement [posted on X](#).

His brother and sister-in-law, Joshua Kushner and Karlie Kloss, followed and [matched the contribution](#) with an additional \$1 million.

Kogan, who worked in the capital of Abu Dhabi as an emissary of the Chabad-Lubavitch movement and who held both Israeli and Moldovan citizenship, had been missing since Thursday. His body was found on Sunday and [authorities arrested three Uzbek nationals](#) in connection with the murder.

Kushner, who brokered the normalization deal between the UAE and Israel in 2020, known as the [Abraham Accords](#), [attended prayers](#) led by the local Chabad center in Abu Dhabi when he led a joint American-Israeli delegation to the country in September 2020.

While Kushner said earlier this year that he [would not return to the White House](#), he is reportedly involved behind the scenes and [could be a key player](#) in a potential normalization deal between Saudi Arabia and Israel. Affinity Partners, Kushner's private equity firm, secured an estimated [\\$2 billion investment](#) from the sovereign wealth fund overseen by Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman.

Kushner and his wife, Ivanka, have a special connection to Chabad. In 2016, the couple [visited the grave](#) of Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson, referred to as the Ohel, in the Queens borough of New York City. Kushner was [behind the 2017 decision](#) by Trump to grant clemency to [Shalom Rubashkin](#), a prominent member of the Chabad community and the former head of America's largest kosher meat processing plant in Iowa, who was convicted in 2009 on fraud charges. The Kushner family's foundation [reportedly donated](#) more than \$342,500 to various institutions and projects associated with the Hasidic sect.

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